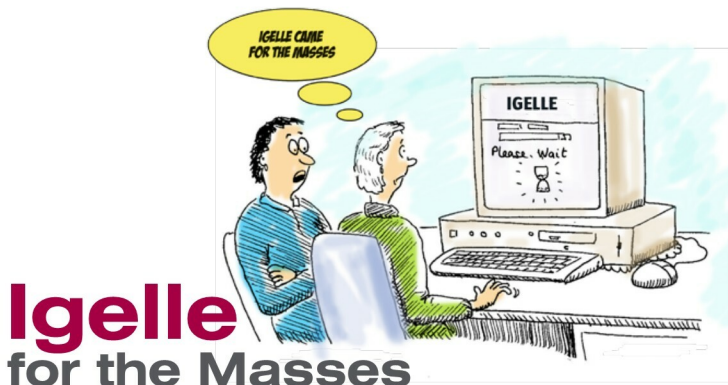




Igelle for the Masses

There are hundreds of different Linux distributions worldwide. However, almost all of them are based on Debian, OpenSuSE, Slackware or Red Hat. But is there a distribution with unique features that is not based on any other grand distro...one that has the flexibility of a regular Linux flavour? It turns out there is—please meet the Igelle!

My first acquaintance with this distribution was quite unusual. The thing that caught my eye was an artistic graphical design of BarPanel—the desktop panel, which is written in Python, and can be used with any Linux distribution. Being curious, I tried to figure out what other products are made in a similar manner, and by a similar developer. As it turned out, there were other software made to be used by Igelle DSV: Melas, a build and packing tool; the Ige Package Manager, and Igelle Connector. This distribution has been declared as a general-purpose operating system for desktop computers, laptops, netbooks and servers. I've spent some time and explored it with my work laptop, as well as with a desktop PC, and even with my MIPS netbook. It works almost flawlessly.

Okay, let's proceed to a real experience. Let's take the ISO image from Igelle's page [see #1 in *References*], burn it to a CD-ROM and try to boot any x86 machine.

First look

The initial bootstrapping is as usual—first the Linux kernel with an *initramfs* image loads into memory, and then the hardware is initialised. After a minute, you'll get a working desktop based on LXDE. Visually, it looks like a contemporary distribution (Figure 1). However, let's dig a little bit deeper, and figure out how it really works.

I've installed Igelle DSV into a virtual machine first, and allocated 1 GB of virtual hard disk space for it, just to see how it works. Don't be surprised that the root partition appears so small. In fact, this is quite a large space, and Igelle can live with it quite happily, despite it being a full installation:

```
$ df -h
Filesystem      Size  Used Avail Use% Mounted on
rootfs          1000M  620M  338M  65% /
udev            500M  1.1M  505M   1% /dev
none            1000M  620M  338M  65% /
/dev/sda1       1000M  620M  338M  65% /igelloroot
/var/run        500M   40K  500M   1% /var/run
/var/lock       500M    0  500M   0% /var/lock
/dev/shm        500M   88K  500M   1% /dev/shm
none            1000M  620M  338M  65% /var/spool/cups
```

The `df -h` command shows that the `/dev/sda1` partition is mounted at `/igelloroot`, where the GRUB loader stores its components. There is another sub-directory that hides here—*igelle/1.0.0*. This contains a big SQUASHFS image file, together with the Linux kernel for this Igelle release, and an *initramfs* disk as well. This concept isn't quite new, and it is used among many popular Live CDs, like Knoppix.